

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single voice and piano. It features a treble clef, a key signature of two sharps (D major), and a 3/4 time signature. The melody is simple and lyrical, with a final cadence. The piano accompaniment consists of single notes and chords, primarily in the right hand, with some left-hand support in the final system. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, with three verses of text provided for each line of music. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at various points: D, Em, A, D, D, G, Asus, A, D, G, Em, F#, D/F#, F#m, Em, A, and D.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.